EXPLORASELF · LINK TO LEAD

The Founder's Blueprint

Building — twelve levels, four domains

You are making the thing and finding who it is for. Everything depends on you, and that is exactly what the first weeks work on.

A founder does not fail at one thing. They run out of clarity in one of four places: who they are, how they handle people, how the work actually runs, and what the market is telling them. This manual works all four, a level at a time, for twelve weeks.

12 levels | **4 domains every level** | **7 clarity points each** | **336 steps** | **48 worksheets**

BUILDING

The twelve levels

01	Count your week	LEAD YOURSELF	FREE
02	Why it exists, in one line	LEAD YOURSELF	FREE
03	Your client, by name	LEAD THE MARKET	FREE
04	Price your hour	LEAD YOURSELF	OPENS WITH ONE SESSION
05	Their yes, in their words	LEAD THE MARKET	OPENS WITH ONE SESSION
06	The 3 talks you’re avoiding	LEAD YOUR PEOPLE	PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB
07	A week you chose	LEAD YOURSELF	PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB
08	Your offer, tested	LEAD THE MARKET	PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB
09	Out of your head	LEAD YOUR BUSINESS	PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB
10	Your first hundred	LEAD THE MARKET	BUSINESS GROWTH HUB
11	The truth you avoided	LEAD YOUR PEOPLE	BUSINESS GROWTH HUB
12	Your next 90 days, on one page	ALL FOUR	BUSINESS GROWTH HUB

BEFORE THE FIRST LEVEL

How to use this

Every level works all four domains and gives one of them the lead. Seven clarity points in each domain, so twenty-eight answers close a level. Twelve levels, twelve weeks.

The seven are the same every time, going a layer deeper at each level:

1. **Name it** — State the thing in one plain sentence, before any explaining.
2. **Evidence** — What is actually true here — something you can open, count or quote.
3. **Gap** — The distance between what you claimed and what the evidence shows.
4. **Cost** — What that gap is costing you now, in money, time or people.
5. **Decision** — The one choice in this that is yours to make this week.
6. **Move** — The smallest proportionate step, and the date it happens.
7. **Review** — What you will check to know it worked, and when.

No step here can be answered by thinking hard. Each one names what to open, what to count and what to write. If you find yourself reflecting rather than looking something up, you have skipped the instruction.

Write in the book. The lines are there because an answer in your head is not an answer. A level closes when all twenty-eight are written, not when you have read them.

One level a week. Faster is not better. The moves have to land in a real week before the next level asks you to look at what happened.

Where a level says a date, write a real one. Where it asks for a number, go and get the number. That is the whole method.

01

LEVEL 1 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOURSELF

Count your week

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have four things that did not exist on Monday: a block of time you defended, one person told plainly what you expect, one process written in ten lines, and three named prospects contacted. Not four insights. Four things that happened.

Lead yourself

The honest inventory — Time, money, energy, non-negotiables

1

NAME IT

In one sentence: what do you spend most of your working time on?

2

EVIDENCE

Open last week’s calendar. Write the three activities that took the most hours, with the hours beside each.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

Where the hours went

Last week only. Open the calendar, not your memory. Five rows is enough.

WHAT YOU DID	HOURS

HOURS YOU CAN ACCOUNT FOR _____

Why hours and not effort. Effort is felt and cannot be compared. Hours can be put beside each other, and the comparison is usually uncomfortable in a useful way. You are not measuring to judge yourself; you are measuring because the week is the only resource you cannot borrow more of.

What this decides. Which single block you will defend this week, and against whom.

3 **GAP**

Compare the two. What took hours that your sentence did not mention?

4 **COST**

What did not happen last week because of those hours? Name one thing.

5 **DECISION**

Name one block of time this week you will protect, and what it is for.

6 **MOVE**

Put it in the calendar now. Write the day and the start time here.

7 **REVIEW**

On which date will you check whether the block survived?

Lead your people

The people already in it — Who your business depends on this month

1 **NAME IT**

List everyone your business depends on this month. Staff, contractors, partners, family.

2

EVIDENCE

Beside each name write what they actually do — not their title.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

Who it rests on

Everyone the business depends on this month. Staff, contractors, partners, family. What they do — not their title.

NAME	WHAT THEY ACTUALLY DO	KNOWS WHAT YOU EXPECT? Y/N

PEOPLE YOU HAVE AN ANSWER FOR _____

What this decides. The one person you will get clear with this week, and the sentence you will use.

3

GAP

Which of them does not know exactly what you expect? Mark them.

4

COST

What went wrong in the last month because of that gap? One example.

5

DECISION

Choose one person to get clear with this week.

6

MOVE

Write the single sentence you will say to them, and the day you will say it.

7 REVIEW

What will you see them do differently? Write it, so you can check.

Lead your business

What actually happens in a week — The delivery, as it really runs

1 NAME IT

Write the main thing your business delivers, in one sentence a customer would recognise.

2 EVIDENCE

List the steps it takes, start to finish, as they really happen. Number them.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The delivery, step by step

How the main thing actually gets delivered — as it really happens, not as it should. Mark the step that exists only in your head.

STEP	WHO DOES IT	ONLY IN YOUR HEAD? Y/N

STEPS WRITTEN DOWN

A process is not a manual. A process is the shortest written account that lets someone else produce the same result. Ten lines that get used beat forty pages that do not. You are not documenting the business; you are removing yourself from one step of it.

What this decides. Which step gets written down first — the one that costs most when you are not there.

3 **GAP**

Which step exists only in your head? Mark it.

4 **COST**

What happened the last time you were not there for that step?

5 **DECISION**

Choose the one step worth writing down first.

6 **MOVE**

Write it now, in no more than ten lines.

7 **REVIEW**

Who will follow it this week without asking you, and on what day?

Lead the market

Who you served, and who paid — Names, not types

1 **NAME IT**

Who do you say your customer is? One sentence.

2 **EVIDENCE**

List the last ten people or companies who paid you. Names, not categories.

3 GAP

How many of those ten match the sentence you just wrote?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

Who actually paid

Count the last ten who paid you. Then count how many of those ten match the customer you say you serve.

OF THE LAST TEN, HOW MANY MATCH YOUR SENTENCE

HOW MANY YOU COUNTED (USUALLY 10)

YOUR STATED CUSTOMER, AS A SHARE OF YOUR REAL ONE

Concentration, in plain words. Who pays you is the only market research you own outright. Everything else is opinion, including yours. When the list disagrees with your sentence, the honest move is to change the sentence or change who you chase — not to explain the gap.

What this decides. Which single kind of customer you aim at for the next twelve weeks.

4 COST

What are you spending — money or hours — reaching people who are not on that list?

5 DECISION

Which single kind of customer will you aim at for the next twelve weeks?

6 MOVE

Name three real people who fit and that you could contact this week.

7 REVIEW

By which date will you have spoken to all three?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

02

LEVEL 2 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOURSELF

Why it exists, in one line

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have one sentence for what this business is for that you would say out loud to a customer, one thing you have stopped paying for, one rule your delivery follows every time, and one customer's own words replacing yours.

Lead yourself

What you are actually for — The reason that survives a bad week

1

NAME IT

Finish this sentence in your own words: "This business exists so that…"

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

The reason, in one line

Write it as a sentence you could say out loud on a bad week without wincing.

I run this so that _____ can _____, and I keep going because _____.

WHO

WHAT BECOMES POSSIBLE FOR THEM

WHAT HOLDS WHEN IT IS HARD

YOUR REASON

What this decides. Whether this reason is strong enough to refuse work that pays.

2

EVIDENCE

Open last month's bank statement. Which three spends served that sentence?

3

GAP

Which spend served something else — and what was it serving?

4 **COST**

What has that cost you, in money or attention, over three months?

5 **DECISION**

Name one thing you will stop paying for, or stop doing, this week.

6 **MOVE**

Write when you will stop it, and what you will tell anyone affected.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you check in thirty days to know it was the right call?

Lead your people

Who you are doing it for — The people your reason serves

1 **NAME IT**

Name one real person your business has genuinely helped. First name is enough.

2

EVIDENCE

Write what they said or did that proved it. Their words if you have them.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The people the reason serves

Three real people your reason is actually for. First names are fine. What changed for them, and how you know.

NAME	WHAT CHANGED FOR THEM	HOW YOU KNOW

CHANGES YOU CAN EVIDENCE

What this decides. Which one you will ask, this week, what actually changed.

3

GAP

How many of your last ten customers could you say the same about?

4

COST

What does it cost you when a customer is not that kind of person?

5

DECISION

Decide the one thing you will ask every new enquiry from now on.

6

MOVE

Write the question, word for word, and where you will put it.

7

REVIEW

When will you read the answers back — and how many will you need?

Lead your business

What the work is for — The output that proves the reason

1 **NAME IT**

Write the one output of your business that matters most to a customer.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Open your last five deliveries. How long did each take, start to finish?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

What the work has to produce

The reason is upstream. Name the output that proves it — something a customer receives, not a feeling.

Every week this business has to produce _____, to the standard of _____, or the reason is not being served.

THE THING PRODUCED _____

THE STANDARD IT MUST MEET _____

THE OUTPUT THAT PROVES THE REASON _____

What this decides. Whether this week produced it, and what you do if it did not.

3 **GAP**

Which of the five took longest, and what made it different?

4 **COST**

What did that difference cost — your hours, their patience, or money?

5 **DECISION**

Name the one thing you will do the same way every time from now on.

6 **MOVE**

Write that rule in one line, and where it will live.

7 **REVIEW**

Which delivery will be the first to test it, and when?

Lead the market

The problem you are paid for — Not the thing you sell

1 **NAME IT**

Write the problem your customer is actually paying to make go away.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find a message, review or email where a customer described that problem. Quote it.

3 **GAP**

How close is their wording to yours? Write both, side by side.

4 COST

What do you lose when you describe it in your words instead of theirs?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

What the problem costs them

Not what you charge. What the problem is already costing the customer every week, before you arrive.

WHAT IT COSTS THEM A WEEK (MONEY, OR HOURS PRICED HONESTLY)

WHAT THE PROBLEM COSTS THEM A YEAR

Cost of the problem. A price is only ever read against the cost of carrying on. Work out what the problem costs before you work out what you charge, and you will stop defending your price and start describing their arithmetic. A machine can do this multiplication in a second; what it cannot do is find out the real weekly figure, which takes one honest conversation with somebody who lives it.

What this decides. Whether your price is a rounding error or a real decision for them.

5 DECISION

Choose their sentence or yours, and commit to one.

6 MOVE

Where will it appear first — and on what day will you change it there?

7 REVIEW

What will you watch for two weeks to see whether it landed?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

03

LEVEL 3 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

Your client, by name

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have one standard you did not break, one conversation you stopped avoiding, one bottleneck named with a number beside it, and ten real names you can work.

Lead yourself

The standard you will not drop — What stays true on a bad week

1

NAME IT

Write one standard you want to hold, however busy it gets.

2

EVIDENCE

Find the last time you broke it. What was happening that week?

3

GAP

What did you tell yourself at the time that made it reasonable?

4 COST

What did breaking it cost — with a customer, a person, or yourself?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

The standard, and what it costs

Three standards you say you hold. Beside each, the last time holding it cost you something, and what it cost.

STANDARD	LAST TIME IT COST YOU	WHAT IT COST

STANDARDS YOU HAVE ACTUALLY PAID FOR

What this decides. Which untested standard you are willing to let cost you something this quarter.

5 DECISION

Decide what you will do instead, the next time that pressure comes.

6 MOVE

Write the sentence you will say, and who you will say it to.

7 REVIEW

When will you look back and count how many times you held it?

Lead your people

The conversation you are avoiding — The one you keep rehearsing

1 NAME IT

Name the conversation you have been putting off. One line.

2 **EVIDENCE**

How many weeks have you been putting it off? Write the number.

3 **GAP**

What are you telling yourself about why now is not the time?

4 **COST**

What has the delay already cost — in work, money or the relationship?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the outcome you want from it. One sentence, not three.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

The conversation, before you have it

The one you keep rehearsing. Write it as four parts, so you walk in with a sentence rather than a mood.

I need to tell _____ that _____. I am asking for _____. If nothing changes, _____.

WHO _____

THE PLAIN THING _____

WHAT YOU ARE ASKING FOR _____

WHAT HAPPENS IF NOTHING CHANGES _____

WHAT YOU WILL ACTUALLY SAY _____

Why the fourth part matters. Most avoided conversations are avoided because the speaker has not decided what happens next. Without that, every reply works, so the conversation goes nowhere and has to be had again. Deciding the consequence is the whole work; saying it is the easy part.

What this decides. The day and time you have it.

6 MOVE

Write the opening line, and the day and time you will say it.

7 REVIEW

What will tell you it went well? Write it before you walk in.

Lead your business

The thing that breaks first — Your real bottleneck, with a number

1 NAME IT

Write the step in your work where things most often get stuck.

2 EVIDENCE

Go back over the last month. How many times did it get stuck there? Count.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The bottleneck, with a number

Find the step that sets the ceiling. How long one unit takes at that step, and how many hours a week that step is actually available.

HOURS A WEEK THAT STEP IS AVAILABLE

HOURS ONE UNIT TAKES AT THAT STEP

MOST YOU CAN DELIVER A WEEK

A bottleneck is one step, not a feeling of being busy. Every delivery has exactly one step that sets its pace. Improving any other step makes the queue longer, not the output bigger. Find the step where work waits, and that is the only place where effort converts into capacity.

What this decides. Whether to raise the ceiling, protect it, or stop selling past it.

3 GAP

What do those times have in common?

4 **COST**

What did the delays cost in hours, and did any cost you a customer?

5 **DECISION**

Choose one change that would halve it.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will change, and the first day it applies.

7 **REVIEW**

How many weeks until you count again — and what number means it worked?

Lead the market

The one person you serve — A list you can work, not a type

1 **NAME IT**

Write the kind of customer you chose in level one, in one line.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Open wherever your contacts live. Write ten names who fit. Real names.

3 **GAP**

How many of the ten have heard from you in the last ninety days?

4 **COST**

What is the cost of a list you never work? Be specific about the month ahead.

5 **DECISION**

Decide how many you will contact each week — low enough that you will keep it.

6 **MOVE**

Write the first three names and the day each one hears from you.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

The list you can actually work

Not a type. Ten named people or companies who fit the customer you chose, with how you would reach each one.

NAME	HOW YOU REACH THEM	BY WHEN

NAMED, WITH A ROUTE _____

What this decides. The three you contact first, and on which days.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you count replies, and what number makes this worth repeating?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

04

LEVEL 4 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOURSELF

Price your hour

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have said no to one thing out loud, written the price of your time as a number, named the one task that should never have been yours, and asked one customer the question you have been guessing the answer to.

Lead yourself

The first no — A standard is only real when it costs you something

1

NAME IT

Write the last thing you said yes to that you should have declined.

2

EVIDENCE

Open your calendar for that week. How many hours did that yes take?

3

GAP

What made you say yes — money, fear of the gap, or not wanting to disappoint?

4 COST

What did those hours cost the thing you say matters most?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

The no, and its price

The work you should refuse. What it would have paid, and what accepting it would have cost you in hours.

WHAT IT WOULD PAY

HOURS IT WOULD TAKE

WHAT THAT WORK PAYS AN HOUR

What an hour of yours is worth. Divide what a job pays by the hours it really takes, including the awkward ones — the admin, the chasing, the rework. The figure is often half what the founder assumed. It will not tell you what to refuse. It will stop you believing a no was expensive when it was free.

What this decides. Which piece of work you refuse, in writing, this week.

5 DECISION

Decide the threshold a request must clear from now on. One line.

6 MOVE

Write the exact words you will use to decline, and keep them somewhere you can copy.

7 REVIEW

When is the next likely request — and how will you know you held the line?

Lead your people

What you are actually asking — The request behind the frustration

1

NAME IT

Name someone whose work has frustrated you recently.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

The request behind the frustration

A frustration is usually a request that was never made. Make it.

When _____ happens, I would like you to _____, because _____.

THE SITUATION _____

WHAT YOU WANT THEM TO DO _____

WHY IT MATTERS _____

THE REQUEST YOU HAVE NOT MADE _____

What this decides. Whether you make it, or drop the frustration.

2

EVIDENCE

Write what you actually asked them for, word for word if you can find the message.

3

GAP

Read it back. What did you assume they would understand that you never said?

4

COST

What has that assumption cost, in rework or in goodwill?

5

DECISION

Decide the one thing you will make explicit next time.

6 **MOVE**

Rewrite the request properly. Write the new version here, and when you will send it.

7 **REVIEW**

What will they do differently if it worked? Name the observable thing.

Lead your business

The task that was never yours — Work you do because nobody stopped you

1 **NAME IT**

List every task you personally did last week that someone else could have done.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Beside each, write how many hours it took. Total them.

3 **GAP**

Which single one would be easiest to hand over or stop?

4

COST

At your own cost per hour, what did last week’s list cost the business?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

The work that was never yours

One task you do because nobody stopped you. Hours a week, and what an hour of yours is worth from the last worksheet.

HOURS A WEEK YOU SPEND ON IT

WHAT AN HOUR OF YOURS IS WORTH

WHAT THAT TASK COSTS YOU A WEEK

Cost that never reaches the books. Founder hours are the one input a business never invoices itself for, which is why they are spent so freely. Pricing them does not make you precious about your time; it makes an invisible cost visible so it can compete with the others.

What this decides. Hand it over, automate it, or keep it and say why.

5

DECISION

Decide whether that one task gets handed over, automated or dropped.

6

MOVE

Write who does it next, or what replaces it, and from which date.

7

REVIEW

When will you check it actually left your week — and what proves it?

Lead the market

The problem they already pay to solve — What is already leaving their account

1

NAME IT

Write what you believe your customer currently pays to solve this problem.

2

EVIDENCE

Ask one real customer what they used before you, and what it cost them. Write their answer.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

What is already leaving their account

What the customer already pays to deal with this problem. Tools, people, workarounds, their own time.

WHAT THEY PAY FOR	PER MONTH

ALREADY LEAVING THEIR ACCOUNT EACH MONTH

Existing spend beats new budget. Money already flowing is the easiest money to win, because nobody has to be persuaded that the problem is real — they are paying for it. The question shifts from "is this worth money" to "is this the best use of money already committed", which is a far better conversation to be in.

What this decides. Whether you compete with a tool, a person, or their patience.

3

GAP

How far was your belief from their answer?

4

COST

What has guessing this wrong cost you in pricing or in pitching?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what that makes your offer worth, and whether your price reflects it.

6 **MOVE**

Write the price you will quote next, and the next person you will quote it to.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you have quoted it three times — and what answer counts as proof?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

05

LEVEL 5 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

Their yes, in their words

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have a written definition of your best customer, a reason they say yes in their words, one hour given back to yourself, and one promise you made that you have now checked.

Lead yourself

Where your energy goes — Not time — energy. They are different books.

1 NAME IT

Write the part of the work that leaves you with more energy than it took.

2 EVIDENCE

Go through last week day by day. Mark each half-day as gave energy, took energy, or neutral.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The energy ledger

Last week again, but a different book. Mark each activity gives or takes — then put hours against it.

ACTIVITY	HOURS THAT GAVE ENERGY	HOURS THAT TOOK IT

NET, ON YOUR FIRST ROW

Two different books. Time and energy do not balance to the same answer. Two hours of the wrong conversation can cost a day of capacity, and a draining week looks identical to a good one on a calendar. Keep both books, because only one of them explains why Thursday went badly.

What this decides. One draining hour you remove, and one giving hour you protect.

3 **GAP**

What share of your week took energy? Write it as a fraction.

4 **COST**

What did the drained days cost — in decisions you delayed or people you snapped at?

5 **DECISION**

Decide one thing to move, shorten or stop so one drained block becomes neutral.

6 **MOVE**

Write the change and the first week it applies.

7 **REVIEW**

Which day will you repeat the marking exercise to see whether it moved?

Lead your people

The promise you have not checked — Trust is a checked action, not another assurance

1 **NAME IT**

Write a promise you made to someone in the business in the last two months.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find where you made it — message, call note, or memory with a date. Write when.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The promise, checked

Three promises you have made and not checked. What you promised, when, and how you will verify it rather than assure it.

TO WHOM	WHAT YOU PROMISED	HOW YOU CHECK IT

PROMISES WITH A CHECK _____

What this decides. Which one you check this week, and how they will know you did.

3 **GAP**

Has it been kept, partly kept, or quietly dropped? Say which, plainly.

4 **COST**

What has the silence cost — their trust, their effort, or your own standing?

5 **DECISION**

Decide whether you will complete it, renegotiate it, or withdraw it.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will say and when. If it is withdrawn, say so to them, not to yourself.

7 **REVIEW**

What will tell you the relationship recovered? Name the signal.

1 **NAME IT**

Write the point where work passes from you to someone else, or to a tool.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find the last three times it passed. What information went with it each time?

3 **GAP**

What was missing at least twice?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

The handoff

Pick the point where work leaves your hands. Four boxes: what you hand over, what you assume they know, what actually goes missing, what you will add.

WHAT YOU HAND OVER	WHAT YOU ASSUME THEY KNOW
WHAT GOES MISSING	**WHAT YOU WILL ADD**

BOXES ANSWERED _____

Four things travel with work. A handoff carries the goal, the authority, the information and the standard. Drop any one of them and the work comes back changed, late or wrong — and it will look like the other person failed. Most handoff problems are a missing fourth thing, not a missing person.

What this decides. What you add to the handoff before the next one.

4 **COST**

What did the missing piece cost — rework, delay, or a customer noticing?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the minimum that must travel with the work every time.

6 **MOVE**

Write that list. Four items at most, or it will not be used.

7 **REVIEW**

Which handoff this week tests it, and who confirms it arrived complete?

Lead the market

Why they said yes — Their reason, not your pitch

1 **NAME IT**

Write why you believe your last customer chose you.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Ask them. One message: “What made you decide to go ahead?” Paste their reply here.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

Why they said yes, in their words

Three customers. Their reason, quoted — not your summary of it. If you have not asked, the row stays empty until you do.

CUSTOMER	THEIR WORDS	ASKED ON

REASONS YOU HAVE IN THEIR WORDS

What this decides. Which one you call, and what you will ask them exactly.

3 **GAP**

Which words in their answer are not in your pitch?

4 **COST**

What has it cost to sell on your reason instead of theirs?

5 **DECISION**

Decide which of their words you will adopt.

6 **MOVE**

Write where it changes first, and on what day you will change it.

7 **REVIEW**

How many enquiries until you can tell whether it worked?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

06

LEVEL 6 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR PEOPLE

The 3 talks you’re avoiding

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have had the three conversations you have been circling, each with a named outcome and a date you can check — and you will know which one changed something.

Lead yourself

What you are protecting — Avoidance is always protecting something

1

NAME IT

Write the conversation you have been avoiding longest.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

What the avoidance protects

Avoidance is never laziness. It is protection. Name what is being protected.

By not _____, I protect myself from _____. The price I pay for that protection is _____.

WHAT YOU ARE AVOIDING

WHAT YOU AVOID RISKING

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

THE TRADE YOU HAVE BEEN MAKING

What this decides. Whether you keep paying that price.

2

EVIDENCE

How many times have you rehearsed it in your head this month? Write the number.

3

GAP

What are you protecting by not having it — the relationship, your image, or the money?

4 COST

What has the delay already cost that thing you are protecting?

5 DECISION

Decide whether you will have it, or let it go honestly. Not both.

6 MOVE

If you will have it, write the opening sentence and the day.

7 REVIEW

What will you notice afterwards that tells you it was the right call?

Lead your people

The three conversations — Named, scheduled, and each with an outcome

1 NAME IT

Name the three conversations you are avoiding. One line each.

2 EVIDENCE

Beside each, write how long you have been avoiding it, in weeks.

3 GAP

Which of the three would change the most if it happened this week?

4 COST

What is each one costing, separately? Be concrete.

5 **DECISION**

Decide the outcome you want from that one. One sentence.

6 **MOVE**

Write the day, the time, and the first line you will say.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

Three conversations, scheduled

Named, dated, and each with the outcome you want written before you walk in.

WHO	OUTCOME YOU WANT	DATE

CONVERSATIONS WITH A DATE _____

What this decides. Nothing further. Put the three dates in the calendar now.

7 **REVIEW**

What will be true afterwards if it worked? Write it before you go in.

Lead your business

What breaks when you avoid — The operational cost of a silence

1 **NAME IT**

Write where in the work an unresolved conversation is currently slowing things.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find the last two times work stalled for that reason. What were the dates?

3 **GAP**

What do people do instead, while they wait for you to decide?

4 **COST**

What has the workaround cost in hours or in quality?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

What a silence costs

One thing that keeps going wrong because something has not been said. How often, and the hours each time.

TIMES A MONTH IT HAPPENS _____

HOURS IT COSTS EACH TIME _____

HOURS A MONTH THE SILENCE COSTS _____

What this decides. Whether the conversation is cheaper than the carrying.

5 **DECISION**

Decide the interim rule that applies until the conversation happens.

6 **MOVE**

Write the rule, and tell whoever needs it. Write when you told them.

7 **REVIEW**

When does the rule expire, or become permanent? Put a date on it.

Lead the market

The customer you should not keep — The one the others are paying for

1

NAME IT

Write the name of the customer who takes the most and returns the least.

2

EVIDENCE

Count the hours they took last month, and what they paid.

3

GAP

What is your effective hourly rate on them? Write the number.

4

COST

What could those hours have gone to instead? Name the specific alternative.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

The customer the others pay for

Your most difficult customer. What they pay you a year, and the hours they really take a year — including the chasing and the rework.

WHAT THEY PAY A YEAR

HOURS THEY TAKE A YEAR

WHAT THIS CUSTOMER PAYS AN HOUR

Cross-subsidy. When one customer takes far more than they pay for, the difference comes from somewhere: usually the attention your better customers would otherwise get. Nobody decided this; it accumulated. Seeing the rate per hour side by side is how it stops being invisible.

What this decides. Keep, reprice, reshape or release — and say which by Friday.

5

DECISION

Decide: raise the price, change the terms, or end it well.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will say and when. Keep it respectful and plain.

7 **REVIEW**

What date will you review whether the decision held?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

07

LEVEL 7 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOURSELF

A week you chose

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday your week will have a shape you chose rather than inherited: one recurring block defended twice, one meeting shortened or killed, one morning spent on the work that only you can do, and a written record of where the hours actually went.

Lead yourself

Where your week actually goes — Measured, not remembered

1

NAME IT

Write how you believe your working week is divided. Rough percentages are fine.

2

EVIDENCE

Open last week’s calendar and your sent messages. Total the hours by activity. Write the real figures.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The week, measured

Total hours you worked last week, and the hours that went to the one thing that matters most right now.

HOURS ON THE THING THAT MATTERS MOST

HOURS WORKED IN TOTAL

SHARE OF YOUR WEEK ON WHAT MATTERS MOST

Share, not hours. A total number of hours tells you how tired you are. A share tells you what the week was actually for. Working more hours almost never moves the share; deciding what to stop is the only thing that does.

What this decides. What you stop doing to move that share by five points.

3

GAP

Where is the biggest difference between what you believed and what you counted?

4 **COST**

What has that difference cost in the last month — specifically, not generally?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one shape change: a block moved, a meeting shortened, or a recurring item removed.

6 **MOVE**

Make the change in the calendar now, for the next four weeks. Write what you changed.

7 **REVIEW**

On which date will you count the hours again, and what number means it worked?

Lead your people

Who your week belongs to — Whose priorities filled it

1 **NAME IT**

Write whose requests most often reshape your week.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Look at last week. How many of your interruptions came from that person or that source? Count.

3 GAP

What do they believe about your availability that is no longer true?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

Whose week was it

The five biggest blocks of last week. Beside each, whose priority put it there.

BLOCK	WHOSE PRIORITY	HOURS

HOURS ACCOUNTED FOR _____

What this decides. One recurring claim on your week that you decline.

4 COST

What has that belief cost you in finished work?

5 DECISION

Decide the new boundary. A time, a channel, or a response window.

6 MOVE

Write the sentence that sets it, and when you will say it to them.

7 REVIEW

What will you see next week if they heard it?

Lead your business

The recurring hour — The thing you do every week without deciding to

1

NAME IT

List what you do every single week without ever choosing to.

2

EVIDENCE

Beside each, write the hours and whether it produces something a customer would notice.

3

GAP

Which one produces least and costs most?

4

COST

What is a year of that item worth, in hours? Multiply it out and write the number.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

The recurring hour

Something you do every week without ever deciding to. Hours each week, annualised.

HOURS A WEEK _____

HOURS A YEAR _____

Annualising. A weekly hour is invisible and a yearly month is not, though they are the same thing. Multiply by fifty-two before you decide whether something is small. This is also the arithmetic a machine will happily do for you — the part it cannot do is admit what the hour is really spent on.

What this decides. Remove it, shorten it, hand it over, or keep it deliberately.

5

DECISION

Decide whether it gets shortened, batched, handed over, or stopped.

6 **MOVE**

Write the change and the first week it applies.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you check it stayed changed rather than drifting back?

Lead the market

The hours that find customers — What share of the week faces outward

1 **NAME IT**

Write how many hours a week you believe you spend finding or talking to customers.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Count last week properly: calls, messages, posts, meetings. Write the real number.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

The hours that face outward

Hours last week that went to finding or talking to customers, against total hours worked.

HOURS FACING OUTWARD

HOURS WORKED IN TOTAL

SHARE OF THE WEEK FACING OUTWARD

What this decides. How many outward hours next week gets, and when they sit.

3 **GAP**

What is the gap between the two figures?

4 **COST**

At your current conversion, what did the missing hours cost in enquiries?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the minimum outward-facing hours you will protect each week.

6 **MOVE**

Put them in the calendar for four weeks. Write the day and time.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you count enquiries, and what number would justify keeping the block?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

08

LEVEL 8 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

Your offer, tested

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have one sentence that says what you do, who it is for and what changes — tested on three people who are not your friends, with their reactions written down.

Lead yourself

What you can say without flinching — The claim you are willing to defend

1

NAME IT

Write what you do, in one sentence, as you would say it to a stranger.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

The claim you will defend

Not marketing. The claim you would repeat in front of somebody who could check it.

We get _____ to _____, usually within _____, and I can show you _____.

WHO

THE RESULT

HOW LONG IT TAKES

THE EVIDENCE YOU WOULD SHOW

THE CLAIM

What this decides. Whether to soften the claim or go and get the evidence.

2

EVIDENCE

Say it out loud once. Write down which part you hesitated on.

3 **GAP**

Why that part? Because it is untrue, unproven, or just uncomfortable?

4 **COST**

What has the hesitation cost — a pitch, an introduction, a price?

5 **DECISION**

Decide whether to prove it, soften it, or cut it.

6 **MOVE**

Write the corrected sentence. One sentence only.

7 **REVIEW**

Who will you say it to this week, and on what day?

Lead your people

How it lands — What they repeat back is what you actually said

1 **NAME IT**

Write your sentence as it stands now.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Say it to three people. Write down what each one repeated back, in their words.

3 GAP

Which part did all three get wrong or leave out?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

How it lands

Say the sentence to three people. Write back what they repeated to you — their words, not a tidied version.

WHO YOU SAID IT TO	WHAT THEY REPEATED

VERSIONS YOU HAVE HEARD BACK

What this decides. Which word you change, based on what came back.

4 COST

What does that cost you every time someone describes you to someone else?

5 DECISION

Decide which word or clause is doing the damage.

6 MOVE

Rewrite it and test it on one more person. Write the new version and their reply.

7 REVIEW

What would a correct repetition sound like? Write it, so you can recognise it.

Lead your business

Can you deliver what you just said — The sentence is a promise to operations

1

NAME IT

Write the promise contained in your sentence. What does the customer expect?

2

EVIDENCE

Open your last three deliveries. Did each one keep that promise? Mark yes or no.

3

GAP

Where does the promise outrun what you can currently do every time?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

Can you deliver what you just said

The sentence is a promise to operations. Hours one delivery takes, against hours a week you can actually give it.

HOURS A WEEK AVAILABLE FOR DELIVERY _____

HOURS ONE DELIVERY TAKES _____

DELIVERIES YOU CAN HONOUR A WEEK _____

A promise is an operational commitment. Every claim in a sentence becomes a task for whoever delivers — often you. Work out capacity before you publish the promise, because the alternative is discovering it in front of a customer who already paid.

What this decides. Change the promise, or change the capacity.

4

COST

What would one failure cost — a refund, a review, a reference you will not get?

5

DECISION

Decide: change the promise, or change the delivery.

6 **MOVE**

Write the change, and which delivery tests it first.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you check after that delivery to know the promise held?

Lead the market

Your offer in one sentence — Who it is for, what changes, and why you

1 **NAME IT**

Write your offer as: for [who], who [problem], we [what], so that [change].

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find three competitors. Write how each describes the same thing, in their words.

3 **GAP**

What do all of you say that means nothing to a customer?

4 COST

What has sounding like everyone else cost you — in enquiries, or in price?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

The offer, and what it earns

Your price for one delivery, and what it costs you to deliver one — materials, subcontractors, anything that only happens because this job happened.

PRICE OF ONE DELIVERY

DIRECT COST OF DELIVERING ONE

GROSS MARGIN

Gross margin, in plain words. Take the price, subtract only the costs that exist because the job exists, and divide by the price. What is left pays for everything that is not a job: your time, the tools, the quiet weeks. Founders who price on effort rather than margin work hard for years and wonder where it went. A spreadsheet will compute this instantly — deciding what counts as a direct cost is the judgement, and it is yours.

What this decides. Price, scope or cost — which one moves this quarter.

5 DECISION

Decide the one true thing you can say that they cannot.

6 MOVE

Rewrite the sentence with that in it, and put it where enquiries arrive. Write where, and when.

7 REVIEW

How many enquiries until you can judge it? Write the number and the date.

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

09

LEVEL 9 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR BUSINESS

Out of your head

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday one part of your business will exist outside your head: written, followed once by somebody else, and corrected where it was wrong.

Lead yourself

What only you believe — The knowledge nobody else has access to

1

NAME IT

Write the thing you know about this work that nobody else in it knows.

2

EVIDENCE

Find the last time that knowledge was needed. Who needed it, and how did they get it?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

What only you know

Three things you know about this work that a competent newcomer would not. Where each came from.

WHAT YOU KNOW	WHERE IT CAME FROM

THINGS NOBODY ELSE HAS ACCESS TO

What this decides. Which one gets written down so it survives you.

3

GAP

How long did it take them to reach you, and what happened while they waited?

4 COST

What would a week of your absence cost right now? Be specific.

5 DECISION

Decide the first piece of that knowledge to put outside your head.

6 MOVE

Write it down now, in ten lines or fewer, and say where it lives.

7 REVIEW

Who will use it this week without asking you, and on what day?

Lead your people

Somebody else’s hands — Written for the person who will actually use it

1 NAME IT

Name the person who would follow what you just wrote.

2 EVIDENCE

Give it to them and watch, or ask them to walk you through it. Write where they hesitated.

3 GAP

Which step assumed something they do not know?

4 COST

What would that assumption have cost if you had not been watching?

5 DECISION

Decide the fix: a sentence added, a step split, or an example attached.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

Written for the person who will use it

Before writing the process: who uses it, what they already know, where they will get stuck, and what they decide for themselves.

WHO WILL USE IT	WHAT THEY ALREADY KNOW
WHERE THEY WILL GET STUCK	WHAT THEY DECIDE THEMSELVES

BOXES ANSWERED

What this decides. What you leave out because they already know it.

6 MOVE

Make the fix now and write what changed.

7 REVIEW

When will they run it again unsupervised, and who checks the result?

Lead your business

The first thing worth writing down — Ten lines, used, not a manual nobody opens

1 NAME IT

Write the step of your work that costs most when it is done badly.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Do it once and write each action as you take it. Number them.

3 **GAP**

Which actions did you do without thinking and nearly leave out?

4 **COST**

What has a badly done version of this cost in the last three months?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what “done correctly” means here, in observable terms.

6 MOVE

Add that definition to the bottom of your ten lines. Write it here too.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

Ten lines

The step from level one, written so somebody else can do it without asking. One instruction a line. Ten lines, no more.

INSTRUCTION

LINES WRITTEN

Written to be used, not to be complete. A process is finished when somebody else produces the result without asking you, not when it covers every case. Write for the common case, name who to ask about the rest, and let the exceptions stay human. Completeness is how documentation projects die.

What this decides. Who follows it this week, and on what day.

7 REVIEW

Which job this week is the first to follow it, and when do you check?

Lead the market

What the customer never sees — The part of delivery that creates the experience

1 NAME IT

Write the part of your process the customer never sees but always feels.

2 EVIDENCE

Open your last three jobs. How long did that invisible part take each time?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

What the customer never sees

Four things you do that the customer never sees. Beside each, what they would notice if you stopped.

WHAT YOU DO UNSEEN	WHAT THEY WOULD NOTICE IF YOU STOPPED

UNSEEN WORK WITH A VISIBLE EFFECT

What this decides. One unseen thing you stop, and one you start naming.

3 GAP

Where did the longest one differ, and did the customer notice?

4 COST

What does inconsistency there cost in repeat business or referral?

5 DECISION

Decide the standard for it: a time, a format, or a checkpoint.

6 MOVE

Write the standard and where it is recorded.

7 REVIEW

Which job tests it, and what will you ask the customer afterwards?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

10

LEVEL 10 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

Your first hundred

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have a hundred names, a working order to approach them in, the first ten contacted, and a record of what each one said.

Lead yourself

What stops you reaching out — The real reason the list stays untouched

1

NAME IT

Write what you tell yourself when you do not contact someone you could.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

What stops the reaching out

The list has been there a while. Name what actually stops you, in a sentence you would not say in public.

I have not contacted them because _____. What I am really afraid of is _____. The smallest version I could do today is _____.

THE REASON YOU GIVE _____

THE ONE UNDERNEATH _____

THE SMALLEST VERSION _____

THE HONEST VERSION _____

What this decides. The smallest version, done before the day ends.

2

EVIDENCE

Count how many days passed since you last contacted a new prospect.

3

GAP

What is underneath the delay — not knowing what to say, or not wanting to hear no?

4 **COST**

At your current conversion rate, what did those days cost in expected revenue?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the smallest version of reaching out that you would actually do daily.

6 **MOVE**

Write it, and the time of day it happens.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you count how many days you managed? What number is a pass?

Lead your people

Who can introduce you — The shortest path to a stranger is a name

1 **NAME IT**

List the people who already know and trust your work.

2

EVIDENCE

Beside each, write one person they know who fits your customer.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

Who can introduce you

Five people who could introduce you to someone on the list. Who they know, and what you would ask for exactly.

WHO YOU KNOW	WHO THEY COULD INTRODUCE	WHAT YOU WOULD ASK FOR

ASKS YOU HAVE WORDED

What this decides. Two you ask this week, by name and by date.

3

GAP

Which of these introductions has the shortest path and the warmest ground?

4

COST

What has not asking cost you, measured in the months since you last asked?

5

DECISION

Decide the one person you will ask, and exactly what you will ask for.

6

MOVE

Write the message. Make it easy to forward. Write the day you send it.

7 REVIEW

What reply counts as a yes, and when will you follow up if there is silence?

Lead your business

What happens when they say yes — The first hour of a new customer

1 NAME IT

Write what currently happens in the first hour after someone agrees to buy.

2 EVIDENCE

Open your last two new customers. What did each receive, and when?

3 GAP

What was different between the two?

4 COST

What does an uncertain start cost — in questions, in confidence, in refunds?

5 DECISION

Decide the three things every new customer gets, every time.

6 **MOVE**

Write them, and where they are triggered from.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

The first hour of a new customer

What happens in the hour after somebody says yes. Six steps, each with an owner. Write it before you need it.

WHAT HAPPENS	WHO DOES IT

STEPS DEFINED _____

What this decides. Which step you will have ready before the next yes.

7 **REVIEW**

Which new customer tests it, and what will you ask them after a week?

Lead the market

Your first hundred, by name — A list long enough to be real

1 **NAME IT**

Write the one-line definition of who belongs on this list.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Build it to a hundred names. Contacts, past enquiries, local businesses, members, anywhere real. Write where they came from and how many.

3 GAP

How many of the hundred have heard from you in the last year?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

How long the list has to be

Work backwards. Customers you want this quarter, and — from your own history, not a benchmark — how many conversations it has taken you to win one.

CUSTOMERS YOU WANT THIS QUARTER

CONVERSATIONS IT TAKES YOU TO WIN ONE

CONVERSATIONS YOU NEED THIS QUARTER

Working backwards. Pipeline arithmetic is multiplication, and it is the one piece of sales maths that cannot be argued with. Use your own ratio, however embarrassing — an industry average describes a business that is not yours. The number it gives you is not a target. It is the honest size of the task, which is what lets you decide whether to accept it.

What this decides. Accept the number, change the ambition, or improve the ratio — and say which.

4 COST

What is the cost of a hundred names you never work? Give it a figure.

5 DECISION

Decide the order: warmest first, or best fit first. Choose one and say why.

6 MOVE

Write the first ten names and the dates each is contacted.

7 REVIEW

When do you count replies, and what number means the list is worth working?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

11

LEVEL 11 · BUILDING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR PEOPLE

The truth you avoided

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday one person will have told you something about your business that you did not want to hear, and you will have written down what you are going to do about it.

Lead yourself

What you do with the truth — How you receive it decides whether it comes again

1

NAME IT

Write the last piece of hard feedback you received about your work.

2

EVIDENCE

Find what you actually did in the week after it. Write the actions, not the intentions.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

What you did with it last time

Three times somebody told you something hard. What you did in the following week — actions, not feelings.

WHAT YOU WERE TOLD	WHAT YOU DID THAT WEEK

TIMES IT CHANGED SOMETHING

What this decides. What you will do differently next time, before it happens.

3

GAP

What did you do with the part you disagreed with — test it, or dismiss it?

4 **COST**

What has dismissing it cost, if anything, since?

5 **DECISION**

Decide how you will receive the next one: what you will say in the moment.

6 **MOVE**

Write that sentence. Short enough to use while defensive.

7 **REVIEW**

Who is likely to give you the next one, and when?

Lead your people

Who tells you the truth — One person, asked on purpose

1 **NAME IT**

Name the people who could tell you something uncomfortable and would.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Beside each, write when they last did it, and what happened.

3 **GAP**

If the list is empty or old, what does that say about how you have responded before?

4 **COST**

What has a year without honest feedback cost you?

5 DECISION

Decide the one person you will ask, and the single question you will ask them.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

The one person, asked on purpose

One person. A specific question. A date. Vague invitations to be honest get polite answers.

I will ask _____ on _____ : _____

WHO

DATE

THE QUESTION, IN FULL

THE ASK

What this decides. Send the message now, before you leave this page.

6 MOVE

Write the question and the day you will ask it. Make it specific — “what am I getting wrong about X”.

7 REVIEW

What will you do with the answer, before you hear it? Write the commitment.

Lead your business

What the work says about you — Evidence you did not ask for

1 NAME IT

Write what you believe the quality of your delivery currently is.

2

EVIDENCE

Open every complaint, revision request or late delivery from the last three months. Count them.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

Evidence you did not ask for

Four pieces of evidence about the business that arrived without being requested. A complaint, a repeat order, a late payment, a referral, somebody leaving.

WHAT ARRIVED	WHAT IT SAYS ABOUT THE WORK

SIGNALS YOU HAVE READ

What this decides. Which signal you act on this week.

3

GAP

What pattern is in them that you have explained away each time?

4

COST

What has that pattern cost in repeat work?

5

DECISION

Decide the one change that addresses the pattern, not the incidents.

6

MOVE

Write it, and the date it starts.

7 REVIEW

How many deliveries until you count again, and what number is a pass?

Lead the market

What the market already told you — The answers you have been given and not used

1 NAME IT

Write what you think the market is telling you right now.

2 EVIDENCE

Open every lost deal from the last six months. Write the stated reason for each.

3 GAP

What reason appears more than once, and have you acted on it?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

What the market already told you

Four things customers have told you more than once and you have not acted on. How many times each, and what you did.

WHAT THEY TOLD YOU	TIMES HEARD	WHAT YOU DID

TIMES THE MARKET SAID SOMETHING YOU DID NOT USE

What this decides. Which repeated thing you finally act on, and by when.

4 COST

What has ignoring the repeated reason cost, in deals?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one thing you will change because of it.

6 **MOVE**

Write the change and where it takes effect, with a date.

7 **REVIEW**

How many enquiries until you will know, and what will you measure?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

12

LEVEL 12 · BUILDING · LEANS ON ALL FOUR

Your next 90 days, on one page

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have a single page naming the next ninety days: one outcome, three priorities with your name beside each, the number that tells the truth weekly, and the hour in your calendar where you check it. Not a plan you admire. A plan you run.

Lead yourself

What you will be different about — The quarter asks something of you, not only the business

1

NAME IT

Look back at your answers in levels one to eleven. Write the one thing about you that came up more than twice.

2

EVIDENCE

Count how many of your levels mention it. Write the number and which ones.

3

GAP

What have you already tried about it, and what actually changed?

4

COST

If it stays the same for another ninety days, what does that cost?

5 DECISION

Decide the one behaviour you will hold for the quarter. One, not three.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

What you will be different about

The quarter asks something of you, not only of the business. One behaviour, with a way to check it.

This quarter I will _____ , instead of _____ . I will know by _____ .

WHAT YOU WILL DO

WHAT YOU DID BEFORE

HOW YOU WILL KNOW

YOUR PART OF THE QUARTER

What this decides. Who you tell, so it is not only yours to remember.

6 MOVE

Write it as something observable, and the weekly moment you check it.

7 REVIEW

What date is the end of the quarter, and what will you look at then?

Lead your people

Who knows the plan — A quarter nobody else knows about is a wish

1 NAME IT

Write who needs to know what you are doing for the next ninety days.

2

EVIDENCE

For each, write what they currently believe the priority is.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

Who knows the plan

Everyone who needs to know the quarter. What they need to know, and when you tell them.

WHO	WHAT THEY NEED TO KNOW	WHEN YOU TELL THEM

PEOPLE WITH A DATE

What this decides. The first conversation, this week.

3

GAP

Where does their belief differ from your plan?

4

COST

What does a team or a partner working to the wrong priority cost in a quarter?

5

DECISION

Decide who you tell, and what exactly you tell them.

6

MOVE

Write the sentence and the day each conversation happens.

7 REVIEW

How will you know they are working to it? Name what you would see.

Lead your business

The number that tells the truth — One figure, weekly, that cannot be argued with

1 NAME IT

Write the single number that would tell you honestly whether this quarter is working.

2 EVIDENCE

Find that number for each of the last four weeks. Write the four figures.

3 GAP

What does the trend say that your impression did not?

4 COST

What has not watching it weekly already cost you?

5

DECISION

Decide the target for the end of the quarter. One number, with a date.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

The number that tells the truth

One figure, checked weekly, that cannot be argued with and that you could be wrong about. Not revenue — something closer to the work.

Every _____ I will check _____. It is now _____. By the end of the quarter it should be _____, and if it is not, _____.

WHICH DAY

THE FIGURE

WHERE IT IS NOW

WHERE IT SHOULD BE

WHAT YOU DO IF IT IS NOT

YOUR WEEKLY NUMBER

One number, not a dashboard. A dashboard tells you everything and therefore decides nothing, and software will happily build you one this afternoon. One number, checked on a named day, with a stated consequence, changes behaviour — because it can be missed, and missing it means something. Choose the figure closest to the work, not the one easiest to collect.

What this decides. The day it gets checked, starting this week.

6

MOVE

Write where the number comes from and who updates it, and put the weekly check in your calendar.

7

REVIEW

Which day each week do you look at it, and what reading triggers a change of plan?

Lead the market

The quarter you can own — Three priorities, named, with dates

1

NAME IT

Write the one outcome that would make this quarter worth it.

2

EVIDENCE

List everything you are currently trying to do. Count them.

3

GAP

Which three of them actually serve that outcome? Cross out the rest.

4

COST

What has doing all of them at once cost in the quarter just gone?

5

DECISION

Decide the three. Write your name and a date beside each.

6

MOVE

Put all three on one page with the number from the Work domain, and say where that page lives.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

Three priorities, with dates

Everything you could do next quarter, then three, in order. The first one is what you do when the week goes wrong.

1. FIRST

2. SECOND

3. THIRD

WHAT SURVIVES A BAD WEEK

What this decides. What you will not do this quarter, written down beside them.

7

REVIEW

Which date is the ninety-day review, and who sits in it with you?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.